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Graduate Recruitment Team

TP ICAP

135 Bishopsgate

London EC2M 3TP

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Energy & Commodities Trainee Broker Graduate Programme in London, with a particular interest in gas and power broking. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. TP ICAP's Energy and Commodities business grew revenue to £233 million in the first half of 2026 despite a sharp fall in oil futures volumes in the second quarter, which shows the value of a broker's network when markets are disrupted.

Much of my work centres on commodity markets. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas (TTF) volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on daily storage, market and news-based data, including a gas-market attention index I am constructing from Google Trends, and tests whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC Commitments of Traders positioning, and published weekly research notes for members.

Sales and trading appeals to me because it joins analysis to a live price and to a client who needs a clear answer quickly. Writing those weekly notes taught me to turn analysis into a view that non-specialists can act on. In nearly two years at KONG, I learned that a recommendation lands only when it fits the person hearing it: by analysing sales patterns and refining our upselling prompts, I raised average customer spend by an estimated 25%. I also take risk seriously; my lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 were built on disciplined bet sizing and a strict bankroll rule.

TP ICAP stands out to me because, as the world's largest inter-dealer broker, it sits at the centre of the energy markets I study, and its graduate programme gives trainees on-the-job learning across Energy and Commodities products before a permanent placement. Broking rewards fast, accurate judgement and trusted relationships, and I would bring a working knowledge of European gas fundamentals to desks where clients expect a broker to understand the market they are trading.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan